Lecture: 3

GLOBAL AND REGIONAL HISTORIES: PERSPECTIVE AND CONTEXT

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POINTS TO CONSIDER

- WHAT IS **GLOBAL HISTORY**?
- WHAT IS **REGIONAL HISTORY**?
- WHY DO THEY NEED TO BE READ TOGETHER?
- CASE FOCUS: **WORLD AND INDIAN HISTORY**
- KEY READINGS: **THOMAS D. HALL, CHAPTERS 1 AND 8**

WHY THIS TOPIC MATTERS

Why study history at multiple levels

- HISTORICAL EVENTS DO NOT OCCUR AT ONLY ONE LEVEL
- LOCAL EXPERIENCES ARE SHAPED BY WIDER SYSTEMS
- LARGE SYSTEMS ARE BUILT FROM REGIONAL INTERACTIONS
- NATIONAL HISTORY ALONE IS OFTEN TOO NARROW
- SCALE CHANGES THE QUESTIONS WE ASK

- HISTORICAL PROCESSES UNFOLD AT MULTIPLE LEVELS
- SCALE SHAPES THE QUESTIONS WE ASK
- DIFFERENT SCALES PRODUCE DIFFERENT EXPLANATIONS
- NO SINGLE SCALE IS ALWAYS SUFFICIENT
- HISTORY IS NOT NATURALLY CONTAINED WITHIN THE NATION-STATE

WHAT IS **GLOBAL HISTORY?**

Main Features

- STUDIES **CONNECTIONS ACROSS BORDERS**

- FOCUSES ON **MOBILITY, EXCHANGE, CIRCULATION**

- EXAMINES **ENTANGLEMENTS** AMONG DISTANT PLACES

- OFTEN CHALLENGES NATION-CENTRED HISTORY/ CHALLENGES ISOLATED NATIONAL NARRATIVES

- EMPHASISES BROAD PROCESSES AND LARGE-SCALE CHANGE/ EMPHASISES BROAD PROCESSES WITHOUT IGNORING DIVERSITY

- WALLERSTEIN'S WORLD SYSTEMS THEORY
- HTTPS://WWW.YOUTUBE.COM/WATCH?V=0HEJGWVAEXE
- HTTPS://WWW.YOUTUBE.COM/WATCH?V=2ETOM0N_NVM

WHAT IS **REGIONAL HISTORY?**

Main Features

- STUDIES A **SPECIFIC HISTORICAL SPACE**
- MAY BE SUB-NATIONAL, CROSS-BORDER, OR MACRO-REGIONAL
- FOCUSES ON **LOCAL DYNAMICS AND INTERNAL DIVERSITY**
- RECOVERS VOICES AND PROCESSES HIDDEN IN LARGER NARRATIVES
- TESTS AND REFINES LARGER HISTORICAL CLAIMS

THOMAS D. HALL, CHAPTER 1: **"COMPARING GLOBALIZATIONS"**

- REJECTS THE IDEA OF ONE SINGLE GLOBALIZATION
- PROPOSES **MULTIPLE GLOBALIZATIONS**
- GLOBALIZING PROCESSES HAVE A **LONG HISTORICAL DEPTH**
- DIFFERENT WORLD-SYSTEMS EMERGED AT DIFFERENT TIMES
- COMPARISON IS MORE USEFUL THAN ONE LINEAR STORY

HALL CHAPTER 8: **NATION, REGION, AND GLOBE**

- HISTORICAL "PLACE" CAN BE UNDERSTOOD AT THREE LEVELS:
  - **NATION**
  - **REGION**
  - **GLOBE**
- EACH SCALE REVEALS DIFFERENT PATTERNS
- HISTORIANS MUST MOVE ACROSS SCALES
- NATION-STATE BOUNDARIES CAN BE MISLEADING FOR EARLIER PERIODS
- ESPECIALLY USEFUL IN THE CONTEXT OF INDIAN HISTORY

BRINGING GLOBAL AND REGIONAL HISTORIES TOGETHER

How the Two Approaches Go Hand in Hand

- GLOBAL HISTORY SHOWS **CONNECTIONS**
- REGIONAL HISTORY EXPLAINS **VARIATIONS**
- GLOBAL HISTORY ASKS: **HOW ARE PLACES LINKED?** IT CAN ALSO BECOME TOO ABSTRACT
- REGIONAL HISTORY ASKS: **HOW DID A PLACE WORK INTERNALLY?** IT CAN BECOME TOO ISOLATED
- TOGETHER, THEY PRODUCE STRONGER HISTORICAL EXPLANATION

WHY INDIA BECOMES CENTRAL TO OUR DISCUSSION

- INDIA HAS ALWAYS CONTAINED **MULTIPLE REGIONS**
- IT HAS LONG-STANDING TIES TO **ASIA, AFRICA, AND THE INDIAN OCEAN**
- ITS HISTORY CANNOT BE REDUCED TO ONE NATIONAL NARRATIVE
- IT ILLUSTRATES BOTH **INTERNAL DIVERSITY** AND **GLOBAL CONNECTEDNESS**
- IDEAL FOR TESTING NATION-REGION-GLOBE FRAMEWORKS

THE INDIAN OCEAN: WHERE REGIONAL AND GLOBAL MEET

Indian Ocean: Region space, global process

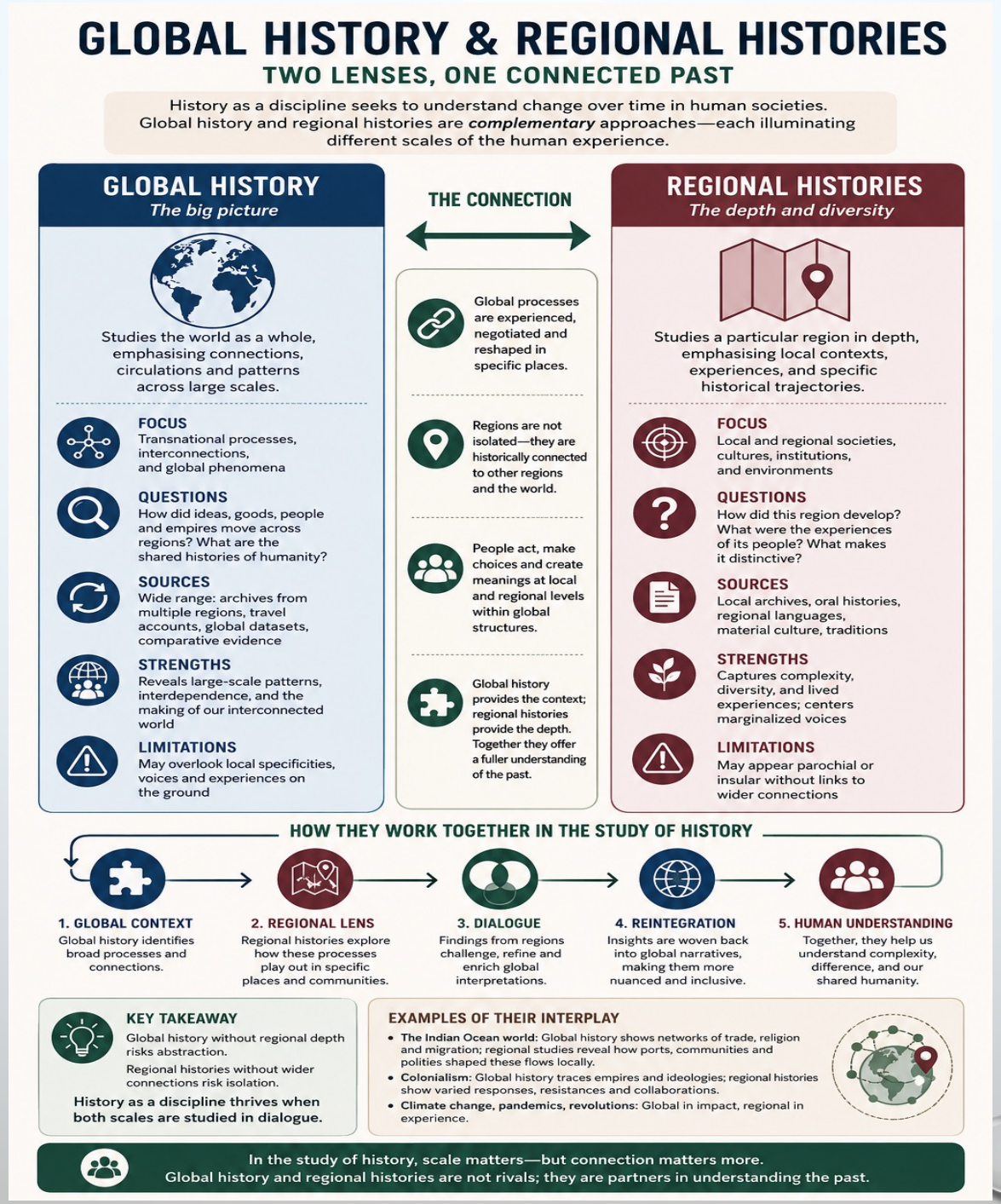
- A COHERENT **MACRO-REGION**
- A **REGIONAL ARENA** WITH ITS OWN HISTORICAL LOGIC
- ALSO PART OF WIDER **AFRO-EURASIAN AND GLOBAL NETWORKS**
- CONNECTED EAST AFRICA, ARABIA, INDIA, AND SOUTHEAST ASIA
- TRADE, MIGRATION, RELIGION, AND EMPIRE MOVED THROUGH IT
- BEST EXAMPLE OF REGIONAL AND GLOBAL HISTORY MEETING



CASE STUDY: VASCO DA GAMA AT THREE SCALES

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=IrOzZwzh1t4

- **NATIONAL FRAME:** A MOMENT IN INDIAN HISTORY
- **REGIONAL FRAME:** ENTRY INTO THE INDIAN OCEAN WORLD
- **GLOBAL FRAME:** SHIFT IN WIDER EURASIAN AND MARITIME SYSTEMS
- PORTUGUESE ARRIVAL CHANGED EXISTING NETWORKS
- IT DID NOT CREATE CONNECTIVITY FROM NOTHING



REGIONAL HISTORY

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depth, context, lived experience

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CONNECTIONS

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movement, exchange, conflict, power

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GLOBAL HISTORY

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patterns, structures, comparisons

CONCLUSION: ONE PAST, MANY SCALES

- GLOBAL HISTORY EXPLAINS **INTERCONNECTION**
- REGIONAL HISTORY EXPLAINS **SPECIFICITY**
- INDIAN HISTORY REQUIRES BOTH
- HALL'S CHAPTERS 1 AND 8 PROVIDE A STRONG FRAMEWORK
- GOOD HISTORY MOVES ACROSS SCALES, NOT WITHIN ONE ALONE

Global history asks how places are connected. Regional history asks how places are constituted. Historical understanding is strongest when we ask both questions together.